



of the space available. Peas are attractive to birds, so use netting to keep them at bay. Keep well-watered, ensuring that peas get plenty of water when in flower and when pods are swelling.

HARVESTING

Peas should be ready to harvest in early summer, within two to three months of sowing. Once the first pods are ready, pinch out the top growing shoots of each plant to encourage more pods to develop. Shoots can also be harvested and eaten. Peas can be stored for a short while, but taste sweetest when fresh.

PESTS AND DISEASES

Slugs and snails are troublesome on young plants and birds on older plants. Protect with netting. To prevent a soil buildup of diseases such as pea leaf and pod spot or downy mildew, ensure that you practice crop rotation.



Downy mildew (left) shrivels leaves. Pea moths (right) devour young peas.